6.1 Introduction

Modern thinking on preschool education concentrates on "how to learn". This process initiates the child to explore,discover and practice thinking skills. And also to process information to understand the world around them. This cannot be taught, but also has to be learnt.

The preschool years are one of the most important stages in a child's life, since it is rapid. The child's cognitive and physical growth lays the foundation for social and personal habits and values. Ninety percent of the child's brain growth occurs during this period, which is mostly influenced by environmental experiences. Hence, varied experiences should be provided during this period. These experiences and skills will be acquired in an ideal pre-school. Preschool education is the foundation for a child's education. It is described as an important period in child's development. The emotional, social and physical development of young children or preschoolers has a direct effect on their overall development and on the adult they will become. That is why pre-school education is so important to maximize children's future well-being.

6.2 Need for pre-school organization

Preschool age (2 1/2 yrs – 5 yrs) is the most suitable age *for acquiring skills*. If this period is not utilized properly for the all-round development of the child, the damage cannot be easily rectified. *Cleanliness and healthy habits* can be taught very effectively at this age.

- *Good habits* and *moral values* can be developed through preschool education by means of interesting, entertaining and goal-oriented play activities. Thus, we can mould children in the right direction.



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